

etch

Sketch without Stress

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Figma Prototype | Figma File

🌷 Target audience

Etch is for creatives who feel burned out and have lost the joy of making. It is a private app where you save small moments that catch your eye, write or talk about why they mattered, and later use them to start a creative project.
You decide what to save. A moment can be a photo, a video or a sound, and you never have to make art to save one. When you start a project, Etch gives you optional prompts based on the moments you picked.

🌷 Design tools

We designed Etch and built the clickable prototype in Figma. Etch is a phone app, so every screen is the size of an iPhone screen (390 × 844 px). Open the prototype on your phone in portrait mode for the best view. It also opens on a laptop, where it scales to fit the window.

🌷 Overview

Task 1: Notice inspiration

Notice something in your surroundings → pin the moment where you are → optionally capture a photo, video, or sound → revisit your private collection.

Task 2: Reflect on moments

Return to saved moments → choose one that resonates → record a text or voice reflection about why it matters → keep the reflection with the moment.

Task 3: Connect to projects

Choose a creative project → select relevant moments and reflections → use an optional prompt as a starting point → record progress as the project evolves.

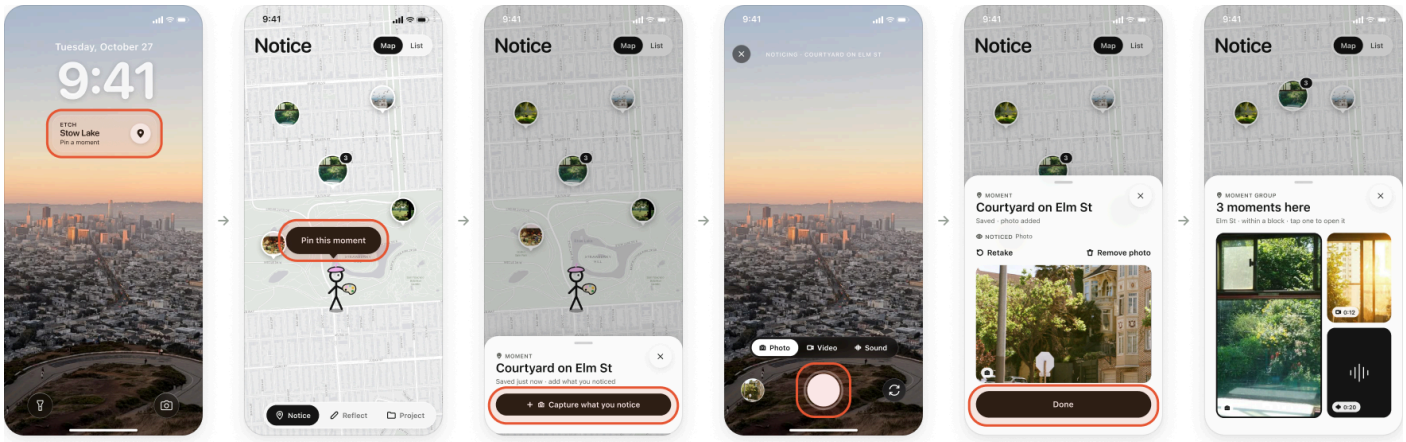
Operating instructions

Task 1: Notice inspiration

Goal: While you go about your day, save something that catches your attention. You pick the place and what to save, and you do not need to make art first.

Screens and components

1. Lock screen widget and Notice map: Start from the Etch widget on the lock screen, or open the app. The map shows only your own moments. Tap Pin this moment to save one where you are. Use Map and List at the top to switch views.
2. Moment sheet: After you pin, a sheet opens with the place name. Tap Capture what you notice to add a photo, video or sound. This step is optional.
3. Camera: Pick Photo, Video or Sound at the bottom, then tap the shutter. On the next screen you can retake or remove the capture. Tap Done to save it.
4. Your moments: Go back to the map, or switch to List, to find the moment again. Pins that are close together show as one group with a number on it. Tap a group to see every moment in it.

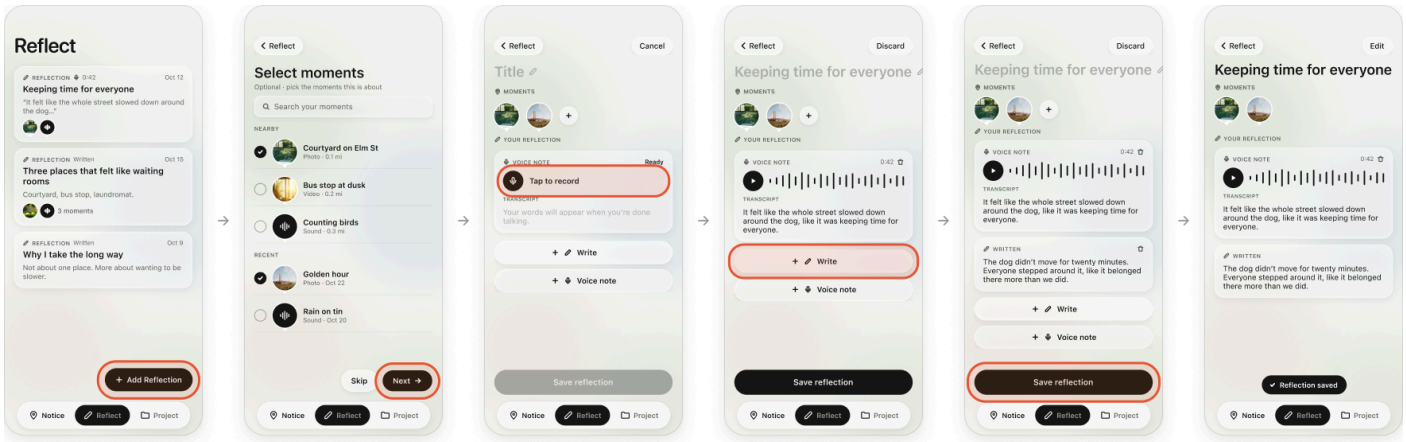


Task 2: Reflect on moments

Goal: Go back to moments you saved and put into words why they mattered to you.

Screens and components

1. Reflect tab: Tap Add Reflection.
2. Select moments: Check the moments this reflection is about, then tap Next. You can also tap Skip.
3. Voice or written note: Tap to record and talk, or tap Write to type. A voice note gets a transcript, so you can read it later. One reflection can have both kinds of note.
4. Save: Tap Save reflection. The reflection keeps its notes and the moments it is about. Only you can see it.



1 **Start a reflection**
From the Reflect tab, tap Add Reflection.

2 **Pick the moments**
Check the moments this is about, or skip this step.

3 **Talk it through**
Tap record and talk for a minute.

4 **Read the transcript**
Your words show up as text. You can add a written note too.

5 **Save it**
Both notes sit in one draft. Tap Save reflection.

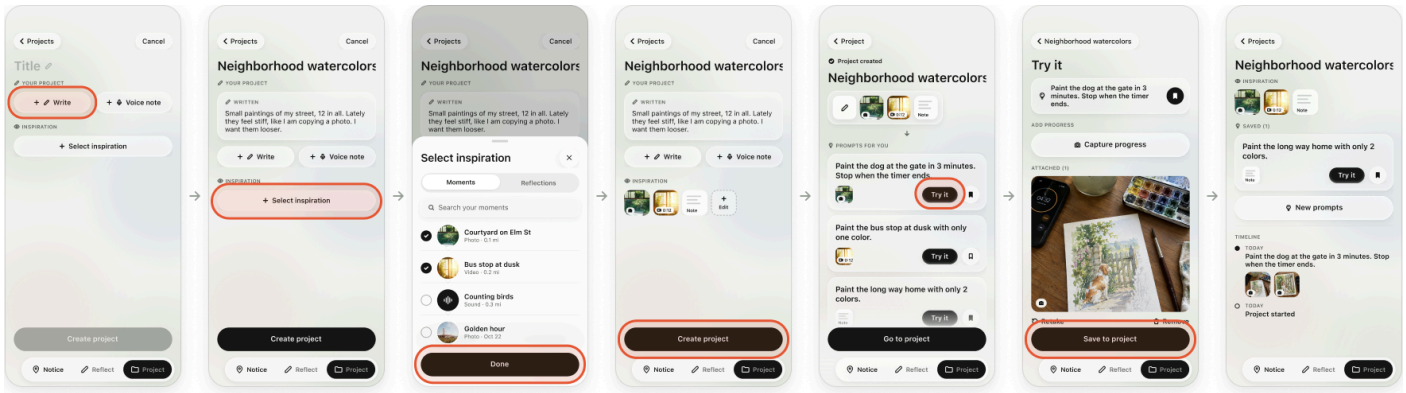
6 **Come back anytime**
The reflection keeps its notes and the moments it is about.

Task 3: Connect to projects

Goal: Use your saved moments and reflections to start a creative project, then keep track of what you make.

Screens and components

1. New project: In the Project tab, give the project a title. Then write or record a note about what you are making.
2. Select inspiration: Tap Select inspiration. Check moments on the Moments tab and reflections on the Reflections tab, then tap Done.
3. Create project: Your note and your picks show together. Tap Create project.
4. Prompts: Etch suggests small things to try, and each prompt shows the moment that inspired it. Tap Try it on one.
5. Capture progress: Take a photo of what you made, then tap Save to project. The prompt and your photo go onto the project timeline.



1 **Start a project**
Give it a title, then write or record what you are making.

2 **Add inspiration**
Tap Select inspiration to pull in moments and reflections.

3 **Pick what fits**
Check moments on one tab and reflections on the other.

4 **Create the project**
Your note and picks show together. Tap Create project.

5 **Get prompts**
Etch suggests small things to try, each linked to what inspired it.

6 **Try one**
Capture your progress with the camera, then save it.

7 **See the timeline**
The prompt you tried moves onto the timeline with your photos.

🌷 Testing setup

Use a phone in portrait mode. You do not need to go outside or bring art supplies, because the prototype uses example places and media. The prototype link opens on Task 1. To start Task 2 or Task 3, open the flow list in the left sidebar of the Figma prototype and select that task. Only the buttons on the task path work. If you get stuck, restart the flow from the sidebar.

🌷 Limitations

This is a clickable Figma prototype, not a working app. The camera, the microphone and GPS are not connected, nothing uploads, and nothing you do is saved. We only built the steps for the three tasks, so some buttons and gestures do nothing. We left these out because this round tests whether the three tasks are clear and easy to finish, and that does not need real device access or a backend.

Hard-coded items

All content is example data that we made: the photos, videos and sounds, the map and its pins, place names, dates and times, moments, reflections, transcripts, projects and prompts. It does not change to match where you are, what you say or what you pick. We wrote the prompts in advance.

Wizard of Oz techniques

In a Wizard of Oz prototype, the team fakes features that do not exist yet. We do not use a hidden person. Pre-made screens fake these features: taking a photo, video or sound, tagging a moment with your location, turning a voice note into a transcript, making prompts from the moments you picked, and saving your moments. When you tap the shutter or Save, the next screen already shows the result.